

Madagascar

Madagascar is the fourth-largest island in the world, and it is amazingly rich in wildlife. More than 250,000 different species of animals live here, and two-thirds of them are found nowhere else on Earth. Sadly, many are endangered.

Location

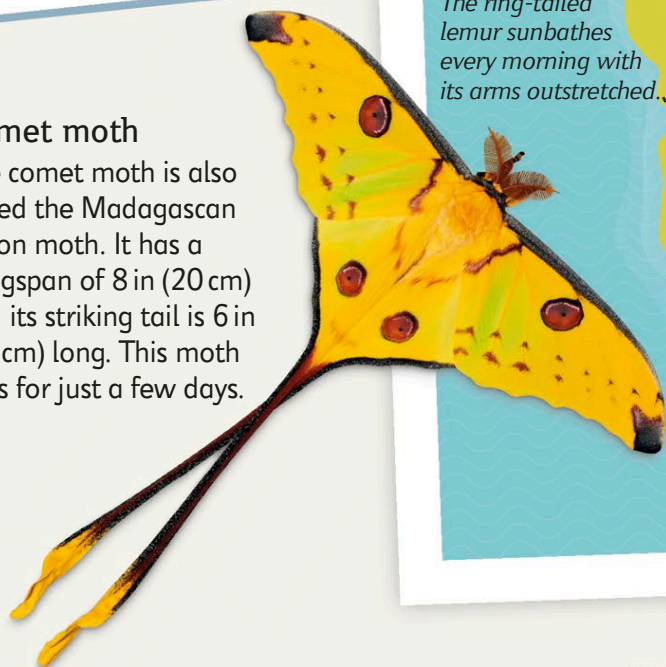
Madagascar is in the Indian Ocean, off the coast of Africa. It has two seasons: hot and rainy, and then cool and dry.



Leaf chameleons are possibly the world's smallest reptile.

Comet moth

The comet moth is also called the Madagascan moon moth. It has a wingspan of 8 in (20 cm) and its striking tail is 6 in (15 cm) long. This moth lives for just a few days.



Leaf chameleon
Just 1.1 in (29 mm) long, this tiny species of leaf chameleon remained unknown to scientists until 2012.

The ring-tailed lemur sunbathes every morning with its arms outstretched.

This strange-looking lemur taps its long middle finger on trees to find grubs—its favorite food.

Ring-tailed lemur

Aye-aye

Lowland streaked tenrec

This hedgehoglike animal has spines sticking out of its fur.

This frog's bright-red color is a warning to predators that it is toxic.

Male ploughshare tortoises try to flip each other over during fights.

The baobab's thick, wide trunk can hold thousands of liters of rainwater.

Male panther chameleons are color crazy! Their body patterns are a mix of pink, blue, orange, green, red, and yellow.



SCALE

0 100 miles
0 100 kilometers

MOZAMBIQUE CHANNEL

MADAGASCAR

Antananarivo

Betsiboka

Lake Alaotra

ANKARATRA MASSIF

Baobab

Mangoky

HABITAT KEY



Mangroves



Mountains



Tropical forests



Deciduous forests

Fossa

Madagascar's largest predator is the catlike fossa. It climbs trees and uses its long tail to help it balance. Fossas hunt many animals, from lemurs to fish.

